

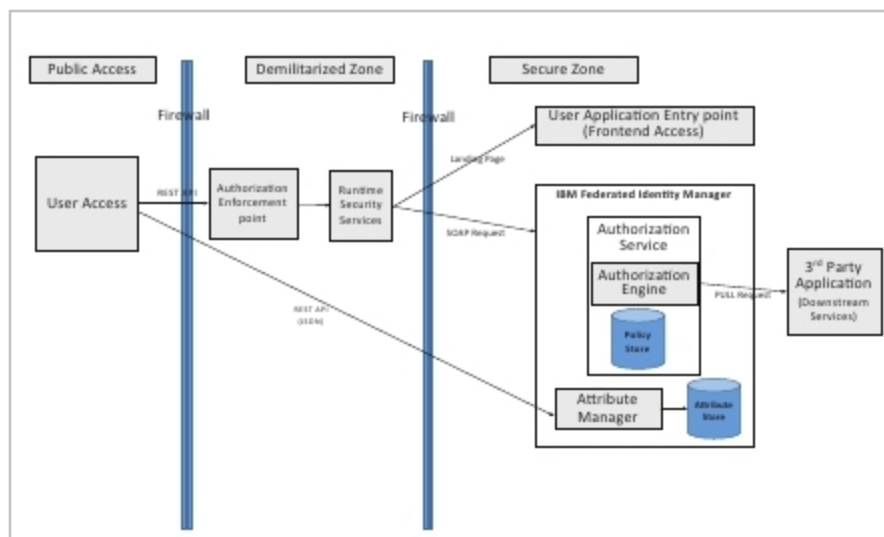


Figure 2: The IBM Tivoli integrated Federated Identity Manager (FIM)

- On-premise application to access cloud based routing to IBM CIAM through REST API call

IBM Security Access Manager provides a data model for user/group based role handling with hierarchy management of policies and user access permissions. It also provides a CIAM solution for context based access control for individual user and group policies, as well as policy based authentication for user accessibility roles.

One of the disadvantages of this solution is that reporting is not available (audits) as an in-built solution. Hence the user has to rely on integrating with other audit and reporting solutions like util logger, log4j, etc.

PingIdentity

If you are looking to prepare a CIAM solution with an integrated cloud offering and SaaS support for a cloud based component offering, PingIdentity would be most suitable. It provides a purpose-built customer IAM (CIAM) solution without compromising on security and flexibility to support mobile integration and cloud adoption. It is integrated with a secure, seamless CIAM solution for single sign-on, data governance, multi-factor authentication and intelligent API security.

Some factors that would influence an enterprise architect to choose PingIdentity for a CIAM solution are:

- Internal support for cloud based operation
- Data model flexibility for re-architecting/re-designing
- Suitability for cloud adoption/migration
- Mobile based offering
- Enterprise solution for cloud based SaaS provider

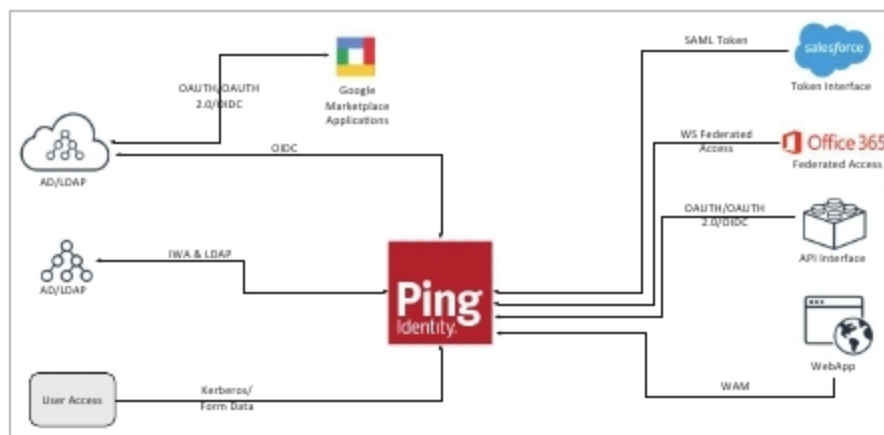


Figure 3: PingIdentity solution offerings for the CIAM architecture

- Cloud based deployment model (for components)
- SaaS and hybrid cloud offering

At the same time, one has to note that with PingIdentity based solutions, a dynamic schema for File of Record is not possible.

StormPath

When you are preparing a CIAM solution for a better customer experience in terms of ease of use and an integrated solution for social networking accounts, then StormPath is the ideal choice. The StormPath CIAM solution provides a digital customer experience combined with an inbuilt data store (without compromising integration with external data providers or cloud service providers) and policy driven group membership. Application integration provides solutions for ID integration with social network user accounts, and provides a consistent experience across channels for customers. This ensures a better user experience (UX) by connecting marketing, business and security teams to protect and handle customer data with ease.

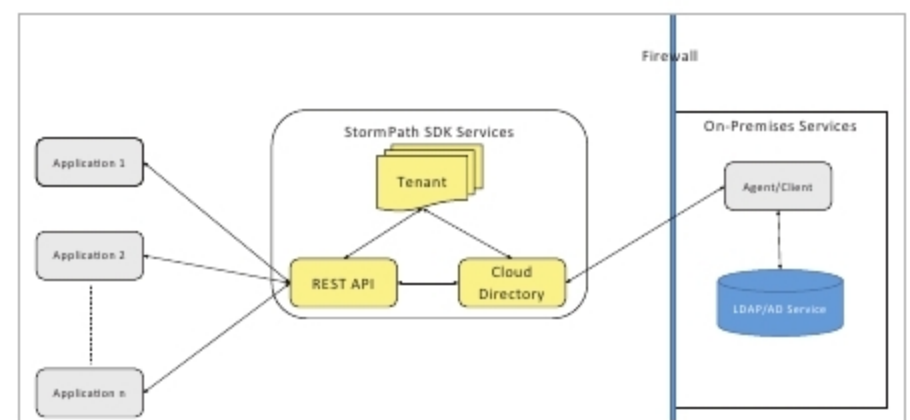


Figure 4: The StormPath offering for CIAM integration

Factors influencing users to choose StormPath as an integrated CIAM solution are:

- Usability of the application and flexibility of user policies
- Data model customisation and security of data handling
- Suitability for cloud adoption/migration
- Custom policy design
- Digital customer experience and flexible design of data store
- Integrated data store and policy based solution
- Group membership and policy driven
- In-built data store

Though there are many advantages of using StormPath in CIAM integration, it does come with heavyweight architecture and complex navigation in workflows.

So, a careful evaluation of the target architecture is really needed before deciding on a particular CIAM solution. **END** 🐧

By: Magesh Kasthuri

The author is an enterprise architect in the Swiss Universal Banking IT division and a senior Distinguished Member of the Technical Staff in Wipro Technologies. He is an Azure certified architect, an AWS certified associate architect and an IBM certified Big Data architect. He is reachable at magesh.kasthuri@wipro.com